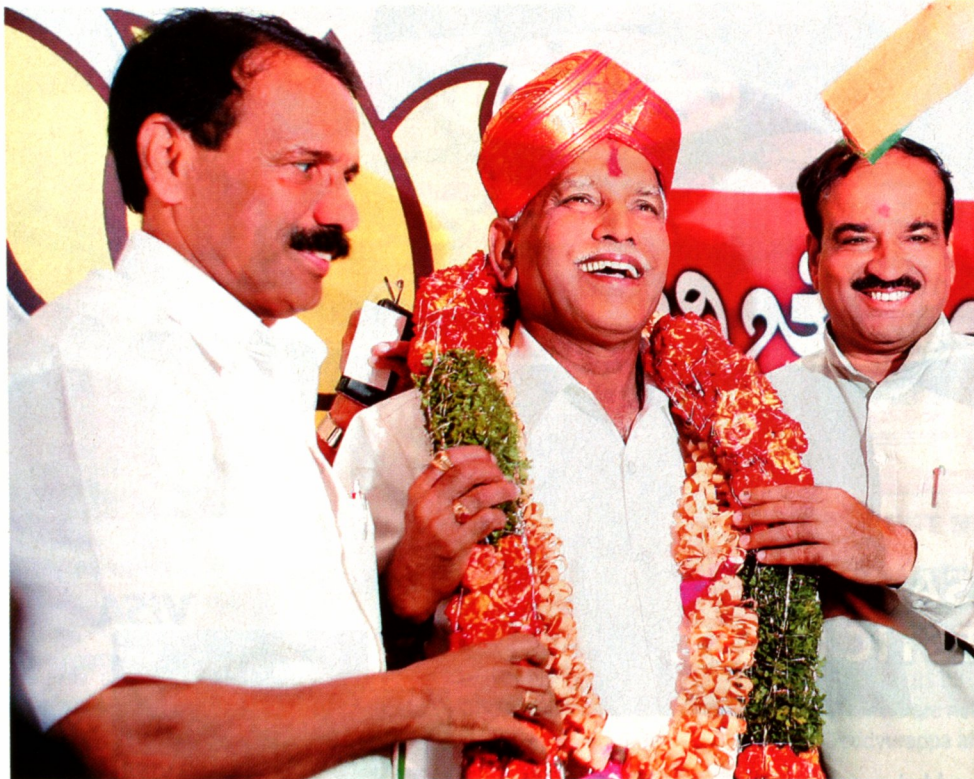
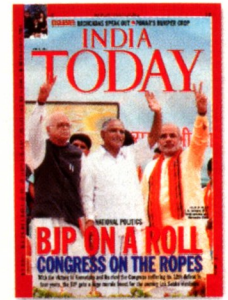




SHAILENDRA



"BJP on a Roll, Congress on the Ropes", June 9, 2008

"This happened as the BJP played its game under a playing captain and Congress under a non-playing one, which neither works in politics nor in cricket."

C.V. VENUGOPALAN, on e-mail

Saffron Surge

The saffron wave is gathering momentum steadily ("BJP on a Roll, Congress on the Ropes", June 9). But if the BJP has to capitalise on it, the party should adopt the Modi Model of development in the states it rules.

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *Mumbai*

Unable to forge any unity within its rank and by seeking subterfuges in the Gandhi family from time-to-time, the Congress party has been, of late, offering power on a plate to the BJP. TYAGARAMAN SANTHANAM, on e-mail

Though the Indian voter enjoys a wider choice among political parties, our democracy has only gotten poorer as we have to choose between two rotten apples. No wonder, people are losing faith in the politicians of the country. VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

The polls in Karnataka are a positive sign as they indicate that the base of blackmailers in the form of "others" has shrunk.

MADHU AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

The elections in Karnataka have sent a clear message that the people are now extraordinarily cautious while exercising their franchise. It is also clear that voters still prefer a single party rule to fragile coalitions.

K.R. SRINIVASAN, *Chennai*

In the euphoria, one should not forget that BJP did not get a simple majority. Its vote percentage is less than that of the Congress and it could only form the government with the help of five rebels, three of whom are former Congressmen. D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Congress leader S.M. Krishna had earlier gone on record to say that a democratic party of

Congress's stature does not announce its chief ministerial candidates. But after biting the dust, he said that had the name been announced, the outcome of the election would have been different. This shows that Krishna is a dynamic leader!

K.R.P. GUPTA, on e-mail

The people of Karnataka have answered prime minister-hopeful L.K. Advani's plea by giving his party "one chance" to provide them good governance. Moreover, they have taught a befitting lesson to H.D. Deve Gowda by checking him in his toppling games. J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

With three consecutive defeats in Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh and now in Karnataka, Congress scion Rahul Gandhi has scored a perfect hat-trick. His stunts like "road shows" and "discover India tours"

have proved to be non-starters. He should, instead, focus on the country's development. SANJAY BORDIA, *Bangalore*

Ungodly Ways

The considerable following that godmen enjoy in Kerala points to the hypocrisy of the average Malayalee ("In God's Name", June 9). The average native has always considered himself to be more enlightened, but now he has proved that he too is as susceptible to the "charms" of godmen as people elsewhere in the country.

P. PRASAND THAMPY, *Thiruvalla, Kerala*

It is funny to know that a larger number of educated men and women, rather than the poor uneducated, have been befooled by these godmen. It is their greed for wealth and comforts that drive them to such people.

S.S. RAJAGOPALAN, *Chennai*